Songwriting Camp

5 day summer camp, 2020 (ages 9-15)

Objectives:

1. *Compose 3 compositions*
    1. *An original duet*
    2. *An original melody over a pre-existing harmonic progression*
    3. *A original beat created on Soundtrap*
2. *Learn about music theory, compositional techniques, and different music making software*
3. *Video concert and party*
4. *Collaborate, make friends, and have fun!*

This camp is open to students (ages 9-15) who have an interest in composition. *No previous experience with composition or improvisation is required.* These sessions will cover the fundamental aspects of songwriting and will provide an opportunity for students to learn notational and recording software. There will be time at the end of each session for questions.

Cost: $150

Guest Artist: David Alvarez III is a Jazz drummer, composer, arranger, and music educator based in the Metro-Detroit area. The drum set was introduced to him at the age of five, growing up playing in church. He has graduated from the University of Michigan in 2017 with a Bachelor's Degree of Fine Arts in Jazz Studies with a Teacher Certification. Since then, he went on tour with the Benny Green Trio, and is a member of the Clayton Brothers Quintet. He currently freelances and teaches music in Southeast Michigan.

Camp Instructor: Meg Brennan received her Bachelors in Flute Performance and Jazz Saxophone from Michigan State University. Currently, she is pursuing her Masters in Music at the University of Michigan under the direction of Andrew Bishop. At the age of 16, she was accepted into the internationally renowned Interlochen Arts Academy where she studied under classical and jazz flutist, Nancy Stagnitta. During her time at Michigan State University, she had the opportunity to play with jazz artists like Christian McBride, Kenny Barron, Peter Bernstein, Rodney Whitaker, Jimmy Cobb, Anat Cohen, and Roy Hargrove. An active performer in Detroit, she has played at the Fox Theater, Cliff Bells, Ford Field, Baker's Keyboard Lounge, and The Whitney. In addition to being an active performer, Meg is dedicated composer. She is working on her first album and plans to have it recorded in 2020.

Camp Schedule

DAY 1 Tuesday, June 30th (1 - 2PM)

Meet & Greet

- Talk about the purpose of the camp
- Introduction to notational software (Noteflight or Finale Notepad)
    - *Assignment:*
        - *put together a playlist of songs that inspire you*
        - *compose an 8-12 bar melody*

DAY 2 Thursday, July 2nd (1 - 2PM)

Intro to Music Theory and Composition

- How to create a melody (*ideas for a blank page*)
- How to develop chord progressions
- Discuss song form
    - *Weekend Assignment:*
        - *Compose a melody over a pre-existing harmonic progression (Meg will send harmonic progressions on Day 1)*
        - *Compose a secondary line for day 1's melody, making it a duet (Collaborative opportunity)*

DAY 3 Tuesday, July 7th (1 - 2:30PM)

Check in/Guest Artist

- Discuss compositions
- Discuss options for recording duets (Acapella/Soundtrap)
- David Alvarez III leads a session on how to make a beat on Soundtrap
    - *Assignment:*
        - *Record duets*
        - *Start making a beat on Soundtrap. This does not have to be formally notated, only recorded in the software.*

DAY 4 Thursday, July 9th (3 - 4PM)

The Final Touches

- Time for individual help
    - *Assignment:*
        - *Finish songs*
        - *Send all recordings to Meg (all participants recordings will be compiled for the final video)*

DAY 5 Saturday, July 11th (1 - 2PM)

Watch Party — Weather permitting, we could potentially have the party at an outdoor park.